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Add Users

⚠ Under Construction

We are still working on the user creation and integration processes. This guide outlines a few currently working solutions.

📄 This Is Inspiration

Our community might come up with better solutions soon. We are seeking contributions to improve this pattern, so please contact us if you have a nicer solution in mind!

Summary

The users we define in this step will be the users that can actually log in to your previously created machines. You can define which user has access to which machine in detail, but in this example all users can log into all machines.

Defining users can be done in many different ways. We will highlight a few approaches here and recommend using clan's [users](#) service.

Requirements

- Estimated time: 30min
- A working clan setup with at least one machine

Adding Users using the service

To add a first *user* this guide will be leveraging two things:

- [services](#): Allows to bind arbitrary logic to something we call an `instance`.
- [services/users](#): Implements logic for adding a single user.

The example shows how to add a user called `jon`:

clan.nix

```

1 {
2     inventory.machines = {
3         jon = { };
4         sara = { };
5     };
6     inventory.instances = {
7         jon-user = { # (1)
8             module.name = "users";
9
10            roles.default.tags.all = { }; # (2)
11
12            roles.default.settings = {
13                user = "jon"; # (3)
14                groups = [
15                    "wheel" # Allow using 'sudo'
16                    "networkmanager" # Allows to manage network connecti
17                    "video" # Allows to access video devices.
18                    "input" # Allows to access input devices.
19                ];
20            };
21        };
22    };
23 }
```

1. Add `user = jon` as a user on all machines. Will create a `home` directory, and prompt for a password before deployment.
2. Add this user to `all` machines
3. Define the `name` of the user to be `jon`

The `users` service:

- creates a `/home/jon` directory.
- allows `jon` to sign in.

- takes care of the user's password.

For more information see [services/users](#)

Alternative 1: Using a custom approach

Some people like to define a `users` folder in their repository root. That allows to bind all user specific logic to a single place (`default.nix`) Which can be imported into individual machines to make the user available on that machine.

```

1 .
2 |— machines
3 |   |— jon
4 # .....
5 |— users
6 |   |— jon
7 |       |— default.nix # <- a NixOS module; sets some options
8 # ... ..
```

Alternative 2: Using

When using clan's `users` service, it is possible to define extraModules. In fact this is always possible when using clan's services.

We can use this property of clan services to bind a nixosModule to the user, which configures home-manager.

`clan.nix`

```

1 {
2   inventory.machines = {
3     jon = { };
4     sara = { };
5   };
6   inventory.instances = {
7     jon-user = {
8       module.name = "users";
9     };
10    roles.default.tags.all = { };

```

```

11
12         roles.default.settings = {
13             user = "jon",
14             groups = [
15                 "wheel"
16                 "networkmanager"
17                 "video"
18                 "input"
19             ];
20         };
21
22         roles.default.extraModules = [ ./users/jon/home.nix ]; # (1)
23     };
24 };
25 }

```

1. Type `path` or `string`: Must point to a separate file. Inlining a module is not possible

users/jon/home.nix

```

1 # NixOS module to import home-manager and the home-manager configuration
2 { self, ... }:
3 {
4     imports = [ self.inputs.home-manager.nixosModules.default ];
5     home-manager.users.jon = {
6         imports = [
7             ./home-configuration.nix
8         ];
9     };
10 }

```

Checkpoint

❖ Under Construction

The user creation process is not yet finished, but if you want to test if everything worked up to this point, you can use `clan machines update`. If the command does not return any errors and asks you to select a password, you can ctrl-c out of it at this point.

Up Next

In the next step, we will add a few recommended services to your clan setup.

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Need help? Reach out to [our community](#).